



Merit Education Group

Unit 1 Pacing Guide

20 days · 17 lessons + 3 assessment/flex days — Intermediate Algebra · Merit Education Group™

Schedule

Authority: specs/U1_Pacing_Guide_v7.md for day-by-day scheduling; the Standards column is owned by the canonical spec's enforced_standards per lesson.

20-Day Schedule

Day	Lesson	Topic	Standards	Bell Ringer	Game	Assessment
1	L1	What Is a Variable?	9.3.5.3, 9.3.5.7, 9.3.5.8	Yes	Translation Match	—
2	L2	Translating Verbal Phrases	9.3.5.3, 9.3.5.7, 9.3.5.8	Yes	Expression Race	—
3	L3	GEMDAS Basics	9.3.5.5	Yes	GEMDAS Challenge	—
4	L4	GEMDAS — Advanced Grouping	9.3.5.5	Yes	Code Match	—
5	L5	Scientific Notation	9.3.5.1	Yes	Power of Ten Relay	—
6	L6	Evaluating — One Variable	9.3.5.7, 9.3.5.8	Yes	Speed Lane	—
7	—	Quiz 1 (covers L1–L5)	9.3.5.1, 9.3.5.3, 9.3.5.5, 9.3.5.7, 9.3.5.8	—	—	Quiz 1
8	L7	Evaluating — Multiple Variables	9.3.5.7, 9.3.5.8	Yes	Small Group Practice	—
9	L8	Real-World Formulas	9.3.5.5	Yes	Independent Practice	—
10	L9	Identifying Terms, Coefficients & Constants	9.3.5.7	Yes	Engagement Activity	—
11	L10	Combining Like Terms	9.3.5.7	Yes	Small Group Practice	—
12	L11	The Distributive Property	9.3.5.7, 9.3.5.8	Yes	Independent Practice	—
13	L12	Dist. Property + Combining Like Terms	9.3.5.7, 9.3.5.8	Yes	Engagement Activity	—
14	L13	Equivalent Expressions	9.3.5.7, 9.3.5.8	Yes	Large Group Practice	—
15	L14	Writing Equivalent Expressions (GCF)	9.3.5.7, 9.3.5.8	Yes	Independent Practice	—
16	L15	Perimeter, Area & Algebraic Expressions	9.3.5.7, 9.3.5.8	Yes	Small Group Practice	—
17	—	Quiz 2 (covers L6–L15)	9.3.5.3, 9.3.5.5, 9.3.5.7, 9.3.5.8	—	—	Quiz 2
18	L16	Translating Real-World Scenarios	9.3.5.7, 9.3.5.8	Yes	Engagement Activity	—

Day	Lesson	Topic	Standards	Bell Ringer	Game	Assessment
19	L17	Financial Literacy: Budgeting	9.3.5.5	—	Budget Balance Challenge	—
20	L18	End-of-Unit Test (covers L1–L17)	9.3.5.1, 9.3.5.3, 9.3.5.5, 9.3.5.7, 9.3.5.8	—	—	Summative

Culture Rotation

Lesson	Culture
L1	Ojibwe (Tribal Nations)
L2	Somali (Somalia)
L3	Hmong (Laos/Thailand)
L4	Dakota (Tribal Nations)
L5	Ethiopian (Ethiopia)
L6	Ojibwe (Tribal Nations)
L7	Karen (Myanmar)
L8	Mexican (Mexico)
L9	Dakota (Tribal Nations)
L10	Liberian (Liberia)
L11	Ojibwe (Tribal Nations)
L12	Iraqi (Iraq)
L13	Puerto Rican (Puerto Rico)
L14	Dakota (Tribal Nations)
L15	Sami (Sápmi / Northern Europe)
L16	Ojibwe (Tribal Nations)
L17	German (Germany)

Career Spotlights

Lesson	Company — City	Job Title	Credential	MN Wage (25th %ile)
L1	Mayo Clinic — Rochester	Medical Lab Scientist	BS	\$63,150
L2	Maurices — Duluth	Merchandise Planner	BS	\$65,653
L3	Target — Minneapolis	Supply Chain Analyst	BS	\$66,934
L4	3M — Maplewood	Industrial Engineer	BS	\$87,526
L5	Best Buy — Richfield	Inventory Specialist	HS	median \$37,330
L6	Mall of America — Bloomington	Retail Ops Coordinator	HS	\$41,226
L7	HealthPartners — Bloomington	Patient Services Coordinator	HS	\$49,254
L8	Xcel Energy — Minneapolis	Power Grid Analyst	BS	\$96,741
L9	DigiKey — Thief River Falls	Electronic Comp Specialist	AA	\$66,477
L10	CVRx — Minneapolis	Clinical Trial Coordinator	BS	\$106,184
L11	The Toro Co. — Bloomington	Assembly Line Tech	HS	\$42,682
L12	Ecolab — Saint Paul	Water Treatment Specialist	HS	\$64,293

Lesson	Company — City	Job Title	Credential	MN Wage (25th %ile)
L13	City of Minneapolis — Minneapolis	Budget Analyst	BS	\$81,349
L14	Cambria — Le Sueur	Stone Fabrication Specialist	HS	\$40,373
L15	Andersen Corp — Bayport	Window Energy Rater	AA	\$80,142
L16	City of Duluth — Duluth	Public Works Inspector	AA	\$80,142
L17	U.S. Bancorp — Bloomington	Financial Analyst	BS	\$80,184

Merit Time Games (L1–L5 Only)

Lesson	Game	Type	Teams	Duration
L1	Translation Match	Matching variables to expressions	4–6	5–7 min
L2	Expression Race	Relay — translate phrase to expression	4–6	5–7 min
L3	GEMDAS Challenge	GEMDAS sequence matching	4–6	5–7 min
L4	Code Match	Advanced grouping sequence	4–6	5–7 min
L5	Power of Ten Relay	Convert/reorder across powers of ten	4–6	5–7 min

End of U1_Pacing_Guide — generated by regenerate_overview.py from the canonical Unit 1 spec.